
INTERNATIONAL AS ENGLISH LITERATURE

Unit 2 Place in literary texts

Thursday 8 January 2026

07:00 UK Time

Time allowed: 2 hours

Materials

For this paper you must have:

- an OxfordAQA 12-page Answer Book
- a copy of the set text(s) you have studied for **Section A**. These texts must not be annotated and must not contain additional notes or materials
- a clean copy of the Oxford International AQA Place in Literary Texts: Combined Poetry Selections Anthology for use in **Section B**.

Instructions

- Use black ink or black ball-point pen.
- Write the information required on the front of your answer book.
- Do all rough work in your answer book. Cross through any work you do not want to be marked.
- You must answer **one** question from Section A and **one** question from Section B.

Information

- The maximum mark for this paper is 50.
- The marks for questions are shown in brackets.
- You will be marked on your ability to:
 - use good English
 - organise information clearly
 - analyse carefully the writers' methods
 - use specialist vocabulary where appropriate.

Section A: Prose

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	1
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Joseph Conrad: *Heart of Darkness*

'In *Heart of Darkness*, though Africa is presented as a rich natural environment it is more significant in the story as a place of danger.'

To what extent do you agree?

[25 marks]

or

0	2
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F. Scott Fitzgerald: *The Great Gatsby*

Daisy says: 'You see I think everything's terrible anyhow' (Chapter I).

To what extent do you agree that *The Great Gatsby* presents American society as simply terrible?

[25 marks]

or

0	3
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Kazuo Ishiguro: *The Remains of the Day*

'Darlington Hall is presented as a grand house, but not in any way as a home.'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

or

0	4
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Aravind Adiga: *Last Man in Tower*

'The future developments in and around the Vakola district of Mumbai are presented as benefitting almost all the characters affected.'

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

or

0	5
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Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie: *Americanah*

In *Americanah*, to what extent do you agree that immigrants are shown to benefit rather than to suffer?

[25 marks]

or

0	6
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Andrea Levy: *Small Island*

‘Ultimately, Levy presents the achievements of Hortense and Gilbert in England as being less significant than the many problems they experience.’

To what extent do you agree with this view?

[25 marks]

Turn over for Section B

Section B: Poetry

Answer **one** question from this section.

Either

0	7
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Thomas Hardy poetry selection

‘Hardy always presents his world as both troubled and beautiful.’

To what extent do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to ‘At a Lunar Eclipse’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

or

0	8
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William Wordsworth poetry selection

‘Wordsworth’s landscapes are more significant as places of suffering than of pleasure.’

To what extent do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to at least two poems.

[25 marks]

or

0	9
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Robert Frost poetry selection

‘All of Frost’s settings are dominated by a mood of sadness.’

To what extent do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to ‘Desert Places’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

or

1	0
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Seamus Heaney poetry selection

‘In Heaney’s presentation of places, he finds conflict or the threat of conflict everywhere.’

To what extent do you agree with this view? You should make detailed reference to ‘The Tollund Man’ and at least one other poem.

[25 marks]

END OF QUESTIONS

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